Utah Inland Port Authority

Interview Presentation to Serve as Municipal Advisor

Tierra Financial Advisors, LLC

June 24, 2025

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Tierra Financial Advisors is registered with the Securities and Exchange Commission and the MSRB. The website for the MSRB can be located at: http://www.MSRB.org. On the homepage of the MSRB website there is a link to an investor brochure that describes protections that may be provided by the MSRB Rules and how to file a complaint with an appropriate regulatory authority.

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Overview of Tierra Financial Advisors, LLC (“Tierra”)

Dedicated to serving land use authorities, development districts, and municipal partners, Tierra’s best-in-class service and strategy ensures transaction success

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57 Development District Financings	50 Years Finance Experience	
$1.0B In Development Finance Bonds		
Specializes in Development Finance Only	45 Special Districts (TX, CO, UT)	

Overview of Tierra Financial Advisors, LLC (“Tierra”)

In our role as municipal advisors, we:

- ✓ uphold a fiduciary duty of loyalty and care, consistently placing our clients goals and interests at the forefront of every engagement
- ✓ look to be viewed as an extension of your staff
- ✓ work hard to solve our clients most challenging financing situations

What value can Tierra bring to the Authority?

- Development finance expertise
- Strong technical and modeling capabilities
- Innovative ideas and creative problem-solving
- Fee and marketing leadership
- Our goal, as your partner, is to put the Authority in the driver's seat when it comes to development finance decisions and execution



Let’s put UIPA in the driver’s seat for decision making!

Innovative Financial Structuring

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Tierra's Unique Capabilities

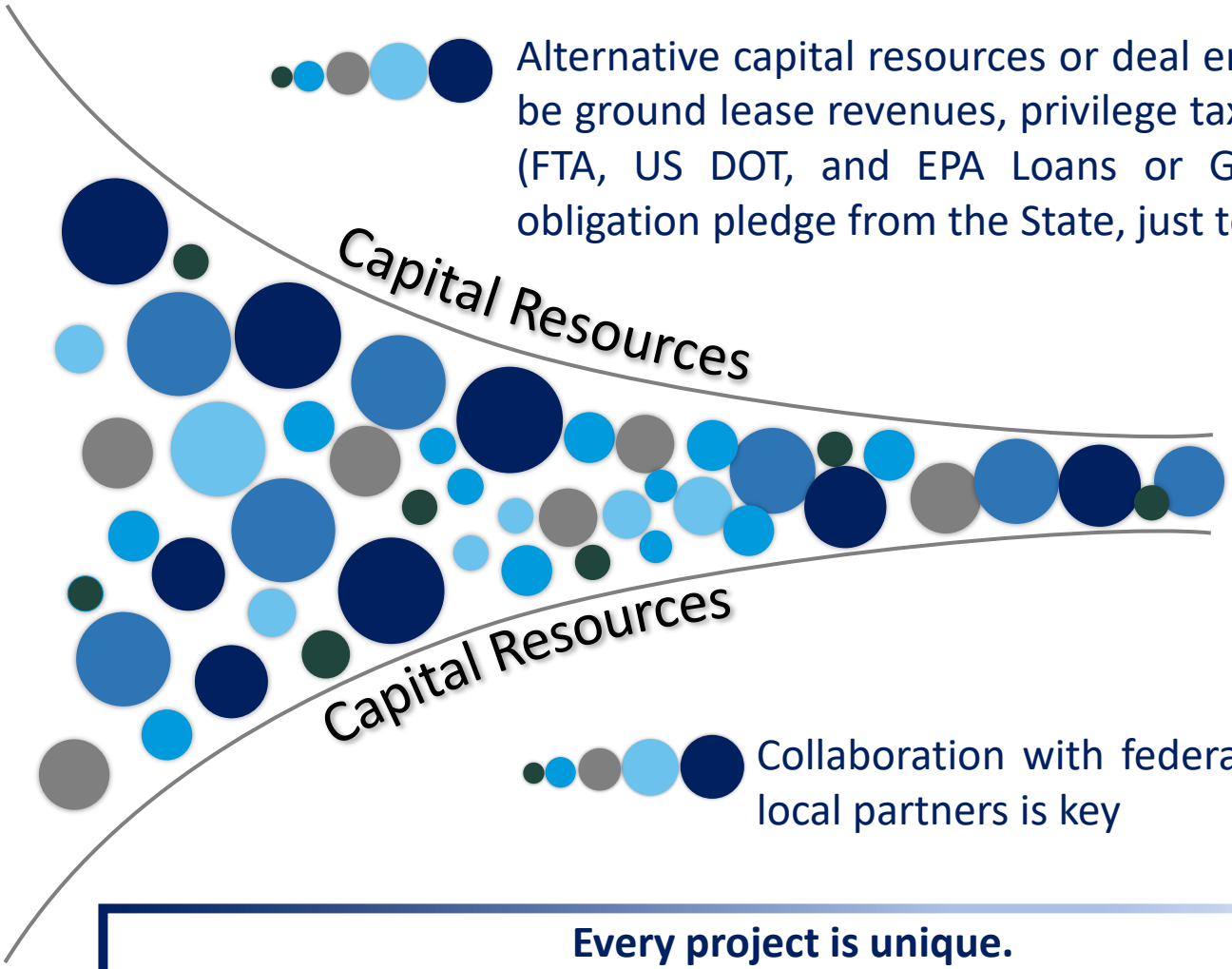
We are confident we can add value and enhancements to the Authority's program



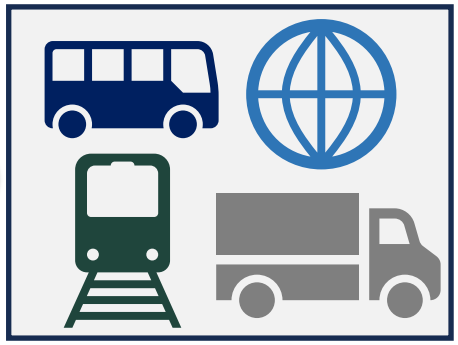
Alternative Capital Resources

On a project-by-project basis it will depend what capital resources or revenue streams are available

Alternative capital resources or deal enhancements could be ground lease revenues, privilege taxes, federal funding (FTA, US DOT, and EPA Loans or Grants) or a moral obligation pledge from the State, just to name a few



Project



Collaboration with federal, state, regional and local partners is key

Every project is unique.
That's what makes development finance so interesting!

Bond Negotiation Strategies

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Bond Negotiation Strategies

Tierra has demonstrated its cost savings leadership and strict oversight across many different development markets

- We have been successful in driving down soft costs because we have the skill set, technical expertise and experience to negotiate with underwriters
- We can provide many of the same services as underwriters thus limiting their justification for charging high fees
- We deliver these services from the vantage point of a fiduciary. **Now, that is powerful!**
- Having a creditable municipal advisor, like Tierra, with high-level technical skills and deep industry experience will help the Authority drive the cost savings conversation



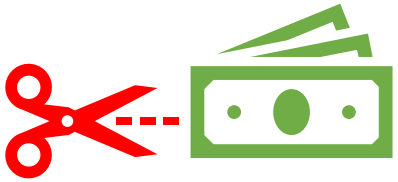
Tierra will bring our tenacious cost savings mindset to the development finance market in Utah

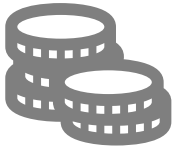
Case Study: Tierra's Bond Negotiations Strategies in TX

- In the development finance market in Texas, Tierra has successfully implemented cost and pricing changes for the benefit of our clients
- While other municipal advisor competitors are content letting underwriters control the narrative on costs and pricing, Tierra has taken the opposite approach
- Traditionally, bonds in the Texas market are sold competitively with terms that allow an underwriter's discount of $30 per bond ($97 dollar price / 3.00%)
- When Tierra entered the market as a municipal advisor, we immediately changed the terms of our clients deals to cap the underwriter's discount at $20 per bond ($98 dollar price / 2.00%)
- This specific change in terms has saved Tierra's clients 1.00% in underwriting fees! Additionally, Tierra charges its clients 50% less than our competitors in this industry
- On a per transaction basis, Tierra saves its clients 2.00% in soft costs which accretes to significant value over the life of the developments











RFP Approach

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Tierra's Approach for Underwriter RFPs

The Underwriter RFP process should focus on 5 main areas…

1	**Pricing performance**	*Proven history of pricing deals with tight spreads over benchmarks*
2	**Sales and marketing platform**	*Effective marketing and distribution to investors*
3	**Willingness to commit capital**	*Examples of committed capital on deals and at what %*
4	**Underwriter's discount**	*Are firms willing to reduce their fees to gain your business?*
5	**References and case studies**	*Gain insight into creative thinking and problem solving*

…with the goal of competing for your business at the most effective cost

- When underwriters compete for your business, the Authority wins!
  - For example, in the Colorado special district market (very similar to Utah PIDs), Tierra has worked diligently to manage underwriting fees and many other "soft costs" within those financings

Underwriting fees are typically the highest soft cost expense. Managing them will lead to savings.



Tierra's RFP Approach Leads to Better Outcomes

- It is important that the Authority partner with a municipal advisor that has technical capabilities and a deep understanding of development finance
- Such a partner can deliver clear and useful information to UIPA leadership and staff – empowering you to make informed, strategic choices
- The right skill set is important to manage underwriters, trustees, paying agents, etc. Anything less will leave the Authority at a disadvantage
- Tierra has lots of experience leading the RFP/RFI process for clients

St. Vrain Lakes Metropolitan District No. 2 - Summary of Underwriter Proposals

Plan of Finance	Wells Fargo	Piper Sandler	DA Davidson	RBC Capital Markets	Stifel
#1 Recommendation by Underwriter	"Alternative 4" in Response • $50.360mm financing o $30.56mm of Senior Current Interest Bonds (insured) o $10mm NR Sub CIBs o $9.8mm NR Junior Cashflow Bonds	"Option 1" in Response • $62.17mm financing o $29.96mm of Bank Loan o $32.21mm NR Subordinate Lien Cashflow Bonds	"Option 5" in Response • Draw on the remaining $12.2mm of 2017C authorization • Wait until 2025 to refund 2017ABC Bonds with an investment grade rating at par	• $57.38mm financing o $35.79mm of Senior Current Interest Bonds (insured) o $21.59mm of Junior	• $48.54mm financing o $28.88mm of Senior Current Interest Bonds (underlying & insured) o $19.66mm NR Sub CIBs & Cashflow Bonds
Considerations	• "Now" Approach • 10yr optional redemption on senior bonds • Appears to be an executable structure	• "Now" Approach • Aggressive assumptions vs. other proposals • 5yr optional redemption on bank loan (at par)	• "Wait and See" Approach • Taking future market risk • Developer continues to borrow from themselves	• "Now" Approach • Developer continues to borrow from themselves	• "Now" Approach • Aggressive annual debt service coverage on senior bonds
Refunding Present Value Savings on Prior Debt Service?	$20mm (Gross) / $5.9mm (Net)	$4.7mm (Net)	N/A	$3.7mm (only 2017A&B)	Unclear
Market for Potential Bond Transaction	Public	Private / Public	Private	Public / Private	Public
Estimated Borrowing Costs for Debt	4.18% Senior / 5.04% Sub / 8.81% Junior (5.159% Combined)	~4.10% Senior / 7.25% Sub (6.046% Combined)	6.00% (rate of 2017C bonds)	~4.24% Senior / 6.00% Sub (4.89% Combined)	~4.58% Senior / 7.50% Sub (5.76% Combined)
New Reimbursement back to Developer in 2022?	Yes, $4mm	Yes. $16mm (most aggressive growth assumption of group)	Yes. $4.92mm (borrowing from developer)	Yes. $12mm (borrowing from developer)	Yes. $4.6mm
Biennial Reassessment Rates used in Proposal	2% / 4%	2% / 6%	N/A	2% / 4%	2%
CO Special District Experience	Yes, strong experience	Yes, strong experience	Yes, strong experience	Yes, experience	Yes, experience
Conclusion	Most executable structure. Issuing Junior Cashflow bonds does not seem ideal. Not a large component of the overall financing par amount. Detailed credit analysis and peer comparison.	Most aggressive reassessment % leads to larger proceeds vs. other proposals. Large cashflow bond par amount. Uncertainty about market execution at that size and proposed market interest rate. Detailed numbers accompanying recommendations.	Served as Underwriter on the District's Series 2017 Bond financing. The Developer would be borrowing from itself again. Detailed credit analysis and peer comparison.	The proposal was not received at the deadline. Issuing $21.59mm back to the developer at 6.00%. Probably not a good solution.	Present value savings is unclear with their structure. Limited information about development practice. Experience working with the District's overlapping municipalities.

St. Vrain Lakes Metropolitan District No. 2 – Bank Loan Discussion

Banks	UMB	Vectra Bank	Bank of Colorado	US Bank	Midwest One	NBH Bank
Loan Sizes Financed / Target Range	$1mm - $30mm / $1mm - $15mm	$1mm - $51mm / $5mm - $40mm	$30mm (too high)	$30mm	$30mm (a little high)	Could do $30mm but might have to syndicate
Final Term / Max Amortization	10yrs / 20 - 25yrs Prefer rapid amortization	20yrs / 30yrs Prefer level debt amortization	20yrs / 30yrs	20yrs / 30yrs On the high end of their range. Prefer level debt service	20yrs / 30yrs On the high end of their range. Prefer level debt service	20yrs / 30yrs
20-year Term Interest Rate (30yr amortization)	N/A (4.52% for 10yr fixed)	4.40% - 4.60%	N/A (3.85% - 4.25%) Lock rates for 5yr increments	4.50%	4.85% (7yr call) 4.65% (10yr call) 4.44% (15yr call)	4.75% - 5.25%
Annual Senior Debt Service Coverage (DSC) Requirement	1.20x	1.20x	1.25x – 1.35x	1.20x – 1.35x	1.30x	1.20x
Redemption Provisions	N/A	10yr redemption (5yr redemption with 3% penalty)	Unclear	Unclear	See rates above	Make-whole provision first 10yrs
Credit Approval Timing	2 – 4 weeks	2 – 3 weeks	3 – 4 weeks	4 – 6 weeks	3 – 5 weeks	2 – 3 weeks
Biennial Reassessment / Reassessment Bump	2% / 10%	2% / 10% – 15%	Unclear	Unclear / 10%	2% / 10% – 15%	2% / Unclear
Other	Must having banking relationship or opportunity. Geographic specific for loans	Close to UW Proposal. Can lock rates for 30 days at 50bps.	Don't like to see high debt-to-AV ratios. 30 – 45 day rate commitments	Can lock the rate for 90 days at 3bps.	Like to see debt-to-AV in range of 90% - 100%	May want banking relationship. Want to see a lower debt-to-AV ratio

Tierra wants to empower UIPA to better outcomes and drive down costs

Training

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Training For All

Complexity & Sensitivity

	Topics	UIPA	Board Members	Financial Personnel	Public
EDUCATION SESSIONS	Bonds 101	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Development Finance 101	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Market Updates	✓	✓	✓	
DISTRICT FINANCINGS	Board Meeting Presentations	✓	✓		
	Lead Financial Consultant & Banking Procurement Process	✓	✓		
	Review Development Application & Model Project Capacity	✓			
POST FINANCING	Continuing Disclosure Agreement Requirements	✓			
	Updates on Changes in Bonding Capacity and Refunding Opportunities	✓			



How can Tierra help?

Education Sessions

- Provide “Bonds 101” or “Development Finance” educational sessions
- Topics discussed include: Issuing Municipal Bonds, Methods of Bond Sales, Bond Credit Ratings, and Understanding the Bond Market
- Sessions can be tailored to the audience (i.e. UIPA might receive material with greater technical depth or specific data, while the public “open house” can focus on foundational concepts and general understanding)

Tailored to meet the needs of the public & Authority

District Financings

- Attend Board meetings to support the agenda of staff, discuss financial information and/or provide project specific details
- Assist the Authority in the evaluation of PID requests for projects given Tierra’s technical capabilities to model cashflows and project feasibilities
- Help lead the Authority’s underwriter, financial consultant and banking procurement process with a standardized approach

We want to be a long-term, trusted partner to the Authority

Post Financing

- Every publicly issued development financing will have a continuing disclosure agreement
- This is an agreement put in place and required by underwriters and future investors of the bonds so that they can track the progress of a development
- Assist with this information reporting as quarterly reporting requirements can be burdensome for the Authority
- Provide ad-hoc updates on changes in bonding capacity and refunding opportunities

Singular focus as municipal advisor for development financings

Vision for the Future

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Vision for the Future

UTILIZE PIDs, the AIB, and other capital resources as vital financial tools to help secure upfront capital for critical project areas across Utah

Tierra can help UIPA by: using its 50-years of public finance experience and $1 billion in development bond financing expertise, to execute the optimal mix of capital resources while minimizing borrowing costs

IMPLEMENT thoughtful financial evaluations of each project area while leading the financing process to ensure transparency, mitigate risk, and limit early influence from developers and underwriters

Tierra can help UIPA by: issuing advice from the vantage point of a fiduciary and evaluating project areas without third-party influence

PARTNER with key stakeholders, including local governments, the community, and trusted advisors (Tierra) to drive informed project development decisions, cost control, and staff efficiency

Tierra can help UIPA by: promoting training and education sessions for key stakeholders, serving as an extension of UIPA's staff to support transparency and address community needs

ADVANCE creative, sustainable developments and financing strategies across project areas by strategically deploying capital to attract public and private investment

Tierra can help UIPA by: accessing its dynamic cash flow and bond structuring models, tailoring them to each project area's unique needs and current capital market conditions



Appendix – Employee Bios

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Employee Bios

Evan Kist, CFA – *Managing Director and Principal*

Evan has 18 years of public finance experience and currently manages Tierra's municipal advisory business and strategy. He is the firm's Principal and oversees supervisory procedures, legal, compliance and regulatory requirements. He also leads the firm's quantitative development, structuring and solution delivery for existing and new clients.

Prior to joining Tierra in August 2019, Evan worked for RBC Capital Markets where he served as municipal advisor to cities, counties, state-level agencies, regional water authorities, transportation systems and school districts throughout New Mexico.

In total, Evan has over 21 years of diverse finance experience, including: investment banking, debt structuring and origination, equity derivatives trading and risk management. He spent 10 years working for Bank of America Merrill Lynch in their New York and Chicago offices covering municipal issuers throughout the country. During that time, Evan covered a broad base of sectors, including: power and energy, transportation, water, infrastructure and special situation borrowers. He worked on over 50 senior managed public finance transactions totaling $8 billion.

Evan Kist graduated Phi Beta Kappa with a degree in Economics and minor in Finance from the University of New Mexico and is also a Chartered Financial Analyst ("CFA") charter holder. He is a FINRA registered securities representative holding the Series 50 and 54 licenses.

Employee Bios

Chris Prugar – *Managing Director*

Chris has over 16 years of public finance experience and has served in a wide variety of roles structuring, executing and managing municipal bond transactions. Since joining Tierra, Chris serves as municipal advisor to many municipal utility districts, including Montgomery County MUD No. 139, Fort Bend County MUD No. 188, Fort Bend County MUD No. 222, Brazoria-Fort Bend Counties MUD No. 3 and East Montgomery County MUDs No. 13 and 14.

Prior to joining Tierra, Chris worked for BofA Securities where he sourced negotiated bond transactions for special districts, water and sewer authorities, cities, counties, school districts, and special projects. Chris' experience includes detailed cash flow modeling, client presentation, and transaction execution. Focused primarily on Texas and other southwest states, Chris has been involved in over $20 billion of transactions for a range of issuers with different financing objectives and execution strategies.

Chris graduated cum laude from Washington and Lee University with a Bachelor of Science in Business Administration. He is a SEC registered municipal advisor holding the Series 50 license.

Employee Bios

Amanda Salome – *Director*

Amanda brings over 15 years of investment and commercial banking experience to her role as Director at Tierra. She is a seasoned finance leader with a strong background in complex municipal and healthcare-related financial strategies, advising a wide range of clients including hospitals, higher education institutions, and not-for-profit organizations across the country.

Prior to joining Tierra, Amanda served as Executive Director at J.P. Morgan Chase, managing a portfolio of 40 marquee healthcare, higher education, and nonprofit clients across the Southern region.

Earlier in her career, Amanda spent over a decade at Merrill Lynch (now BofA Securities), where she helped lead over 70 bond transactions totaling more than $9 billion in par value across 20 states. Her work included the landmark $1.8 billion merger of Providence Health & Services with St. Joseph Health System, creating Providence St. Joseph Health, one of the largest not-for-profit health systems in the U.S.

Amanda holds a BA in Economics and Geographical Studies from the University of Chicago. She is a SEC registered municipal advisor holding the Series 50 license.

Tierra's Municipal Finance Experience & Attributes

- Specialize in serving as municipal advisor to special districts and land use clients
- Extensive knowledge of general municipal finance
- Collaborative advisor with a service-orientated approach
- Experience with complex, multiphase projects
- Proven track record of providing clients with innovative ideas and solutions
- Superior technical abilities (as it relates to cash flow modeling and bond structuring)
- Sustainability/Energy Conservation Project Finance Experience
- Methodical in reviewing legal and relevant deal-related documentation
- Lead solicitation and selection process for underwriters, trustees, general counsel and other related professional services
- Extensive experience in long-term strategic financial planning
- Thorough understanding of public finance laws
- Passionate problem-solvers and creative thinkers
- Knowledge and experience with a wide variety of debt structures, products, credits, and funding mechanisms including all that are contemplated by the Authority
- Leadership in the marketing and pricing of municipal securities